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Room to Grow in the AI Economy

What should we teach and assess when AI answers everything?

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Ministry of Education THE KOREA ECONOMIC DAILY KRIVET Korea Research Institute for Vocational Education & Training

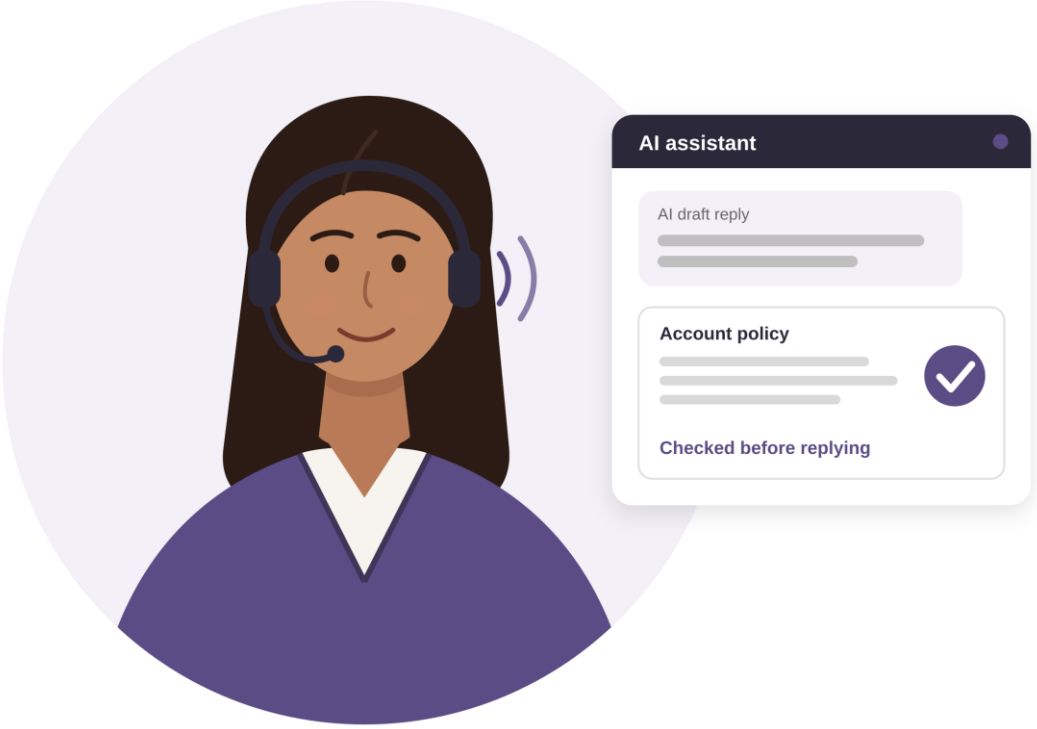
Meet Jiyoung

She has answered phones at a bank for 11 years.

An AI assistant now takes the routine calls.

What reaches her are the hard calls: a widow whose account is frozen, a shop owner who cannot pay his staff.

She learned, without anyone teaching her, to check the AI's answers against bank policy.



What her record says

Customer service representative, 11 years

What she can do

Handle the calls the AI cannot. Check the AI before trusting it.

Her bank is reorganizing and cannot tell which of its 2,000 representatives can do what she does.

Does working with AI build expertise?

Randomized trial with 133 patent lawyers at 11 U.S. law firms over 3 months

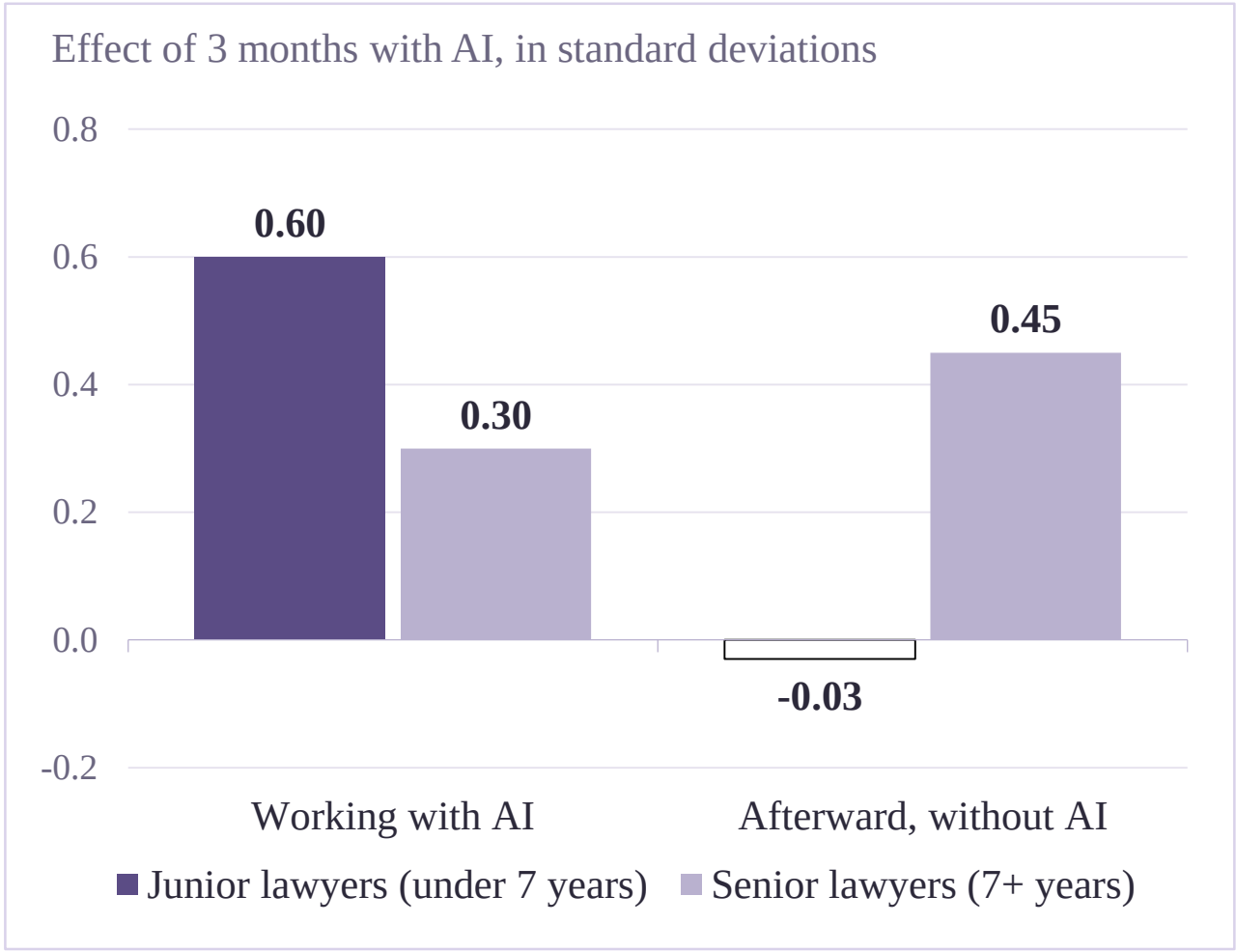
With the AI assistant, everyone's work improved.

Junior lawyers gained the most.

Tested afterward without AI, senior lawyers who had used it were better.

Junior lawyers were not.

Work produced with AI does not show who has the expertise.

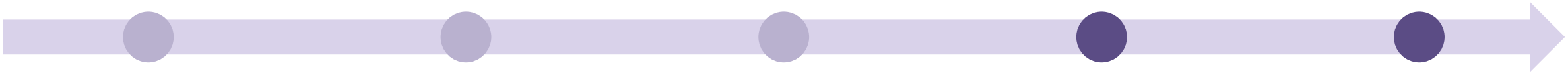


Autor, Rodchenko, Martin, Iscenko, Strand, Pearl & Ferere, NBER Working Paper 35720 (2026).

From telling to showing

Telling

Showing



Credential	Self-report	Interview or exam	Work sample with AI	Feedback and retry
describes the past	describes intentions	answers questions about the work	shows the work	shows growth

AI made this side easy to fake.

It made this side possible at scale.

Similar deliverable but different approaches

Example task: Plan a one-day working session for a supervisor

A	Read the supervisor's email	Ask the AI to draft the cost table	**Open the room file**	**Open the catering file**	**Catch a conflict the AI missed**	Submit the plan
B	Paste the email into the AI	Edit the AI draft for tone	*5 of 7 files never opened*			Submit the plan

If you score only the deliverable, they look similar.

If you score the work trace, the record of every step, there is a big gap.

AI broke the old proxies for skill

But AI makes it possible to observe, measure, and improve skills in context.

1 Observe

Work simulations record how people work with AI and with other people.

2 Measure

Scoring is grounded in what the person did in the task.

3 Improve

Feedback with opportuniti es to try again, shows how much a person grows.

Three human capacities that grow in value

AI fluency

Working with AI (in teams)

Delegation: what to hand AI

Description: how you ask

Discernment: checking outputs

Diligence: taking responsibility for results

Dakan & Feller, AI Fluency Framework (2025).

Relational fluency

Working with people

Managing conflict, influencing others, leading, and teamwork.

Practice and learn using realistic conversational scenarios.

Adaptive flexibility

Learning quickly

How much a person improves over time with feedback.

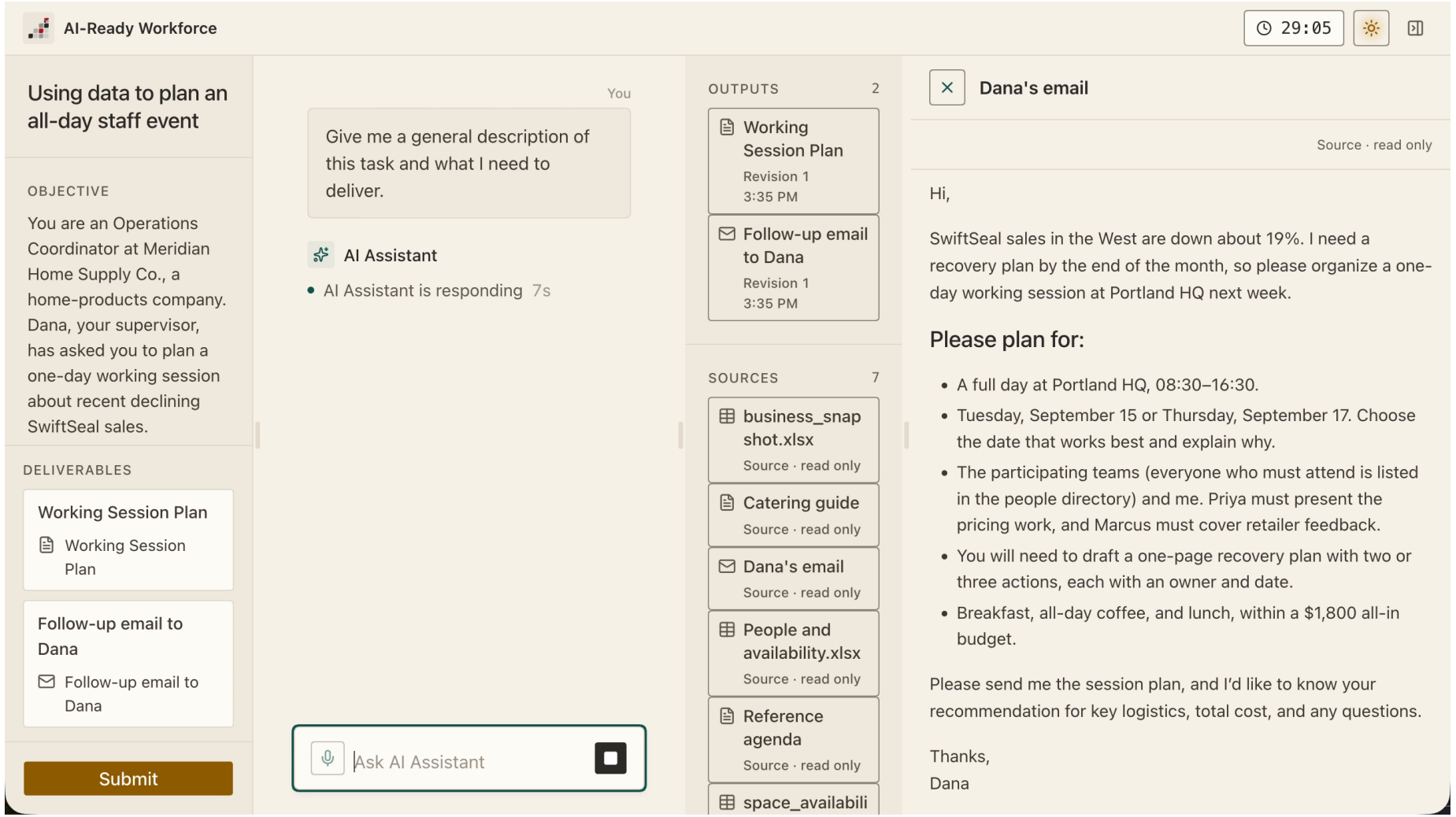
Effective uptake of feedback and use of new approaches.

All three can grow with practice and feedback.

A work simulation with an AI assistant

Employers help design tasks for their own jobs

The workspace:
the task, AI assistant,
and the source files

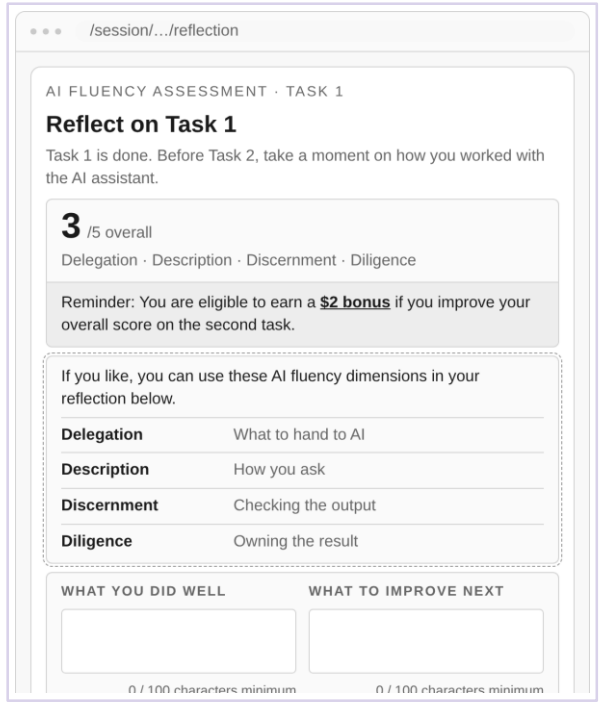


AI Fluency Feedback Experiment

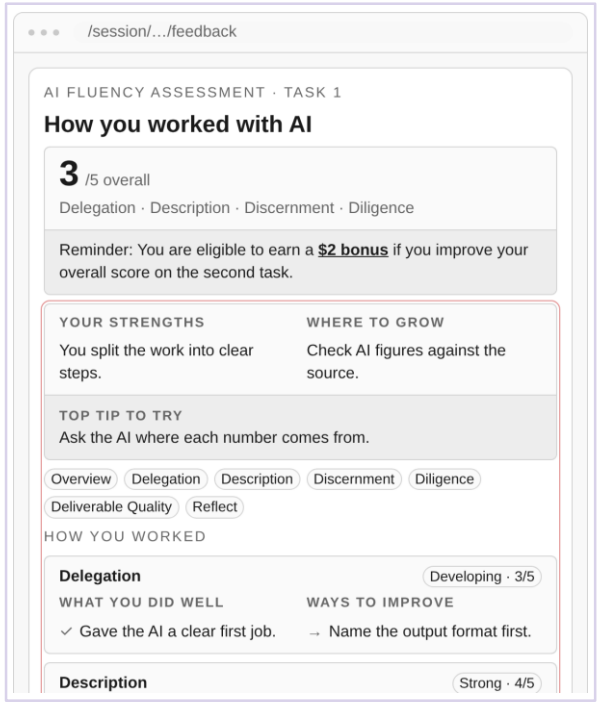
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Work Task → **Feedback condition (see below)** → Similar Work Task → Overall Feedback

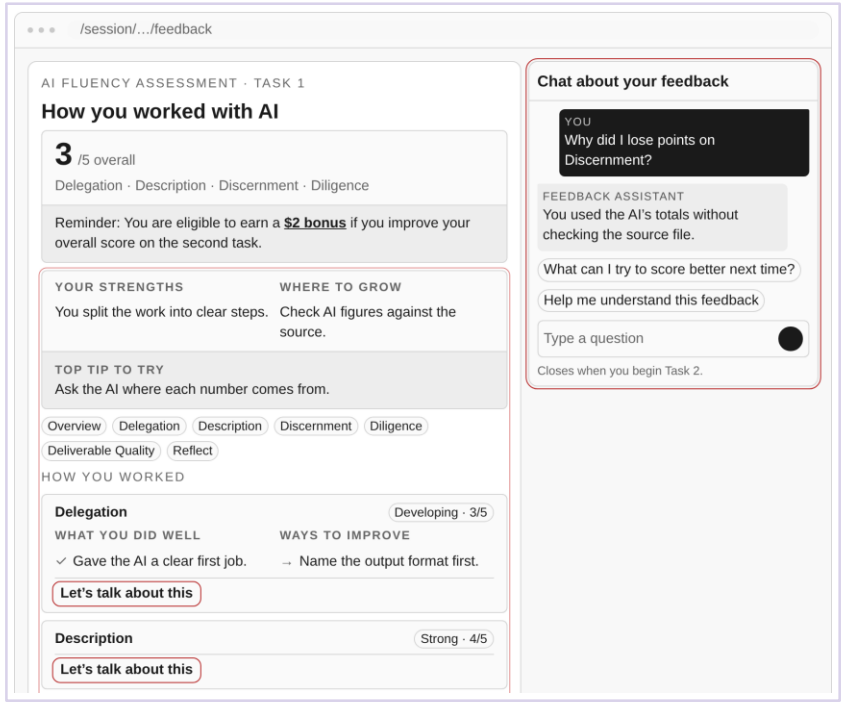
Score only



+ Personalized Feedback



+ Chat



Preregistered randomized experiment with 233 U.S. adults

Self-ratings did not predict how people worked

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7.6 of 10

average self-rating of AI skills

78%

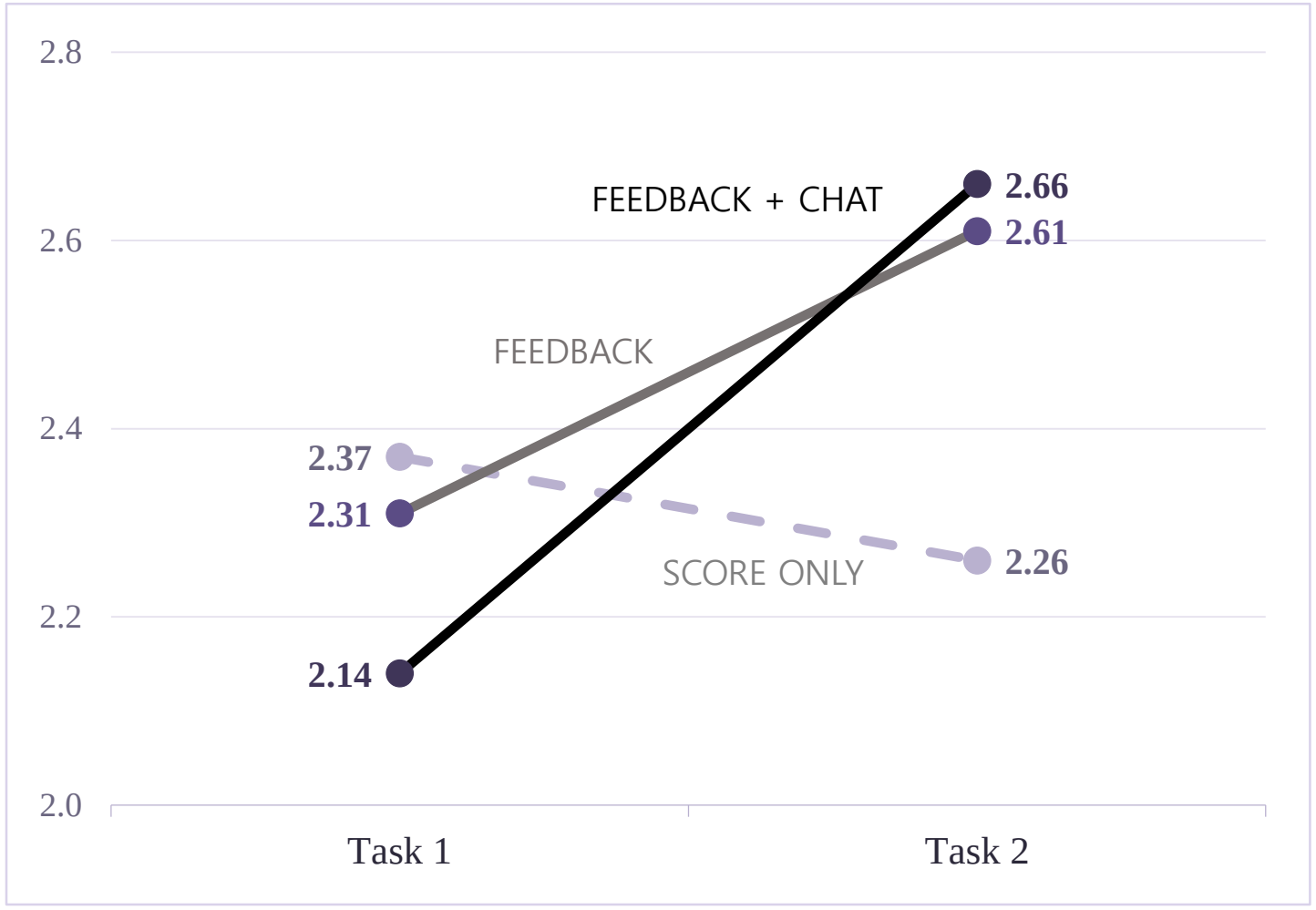
scored below the midpoint on the first task

≈ 0

correlation of self-ratings with behavior



Scores rose with feedback, but not without it



Improvement over Task 1

Feedback + Chat: + 0.52 points

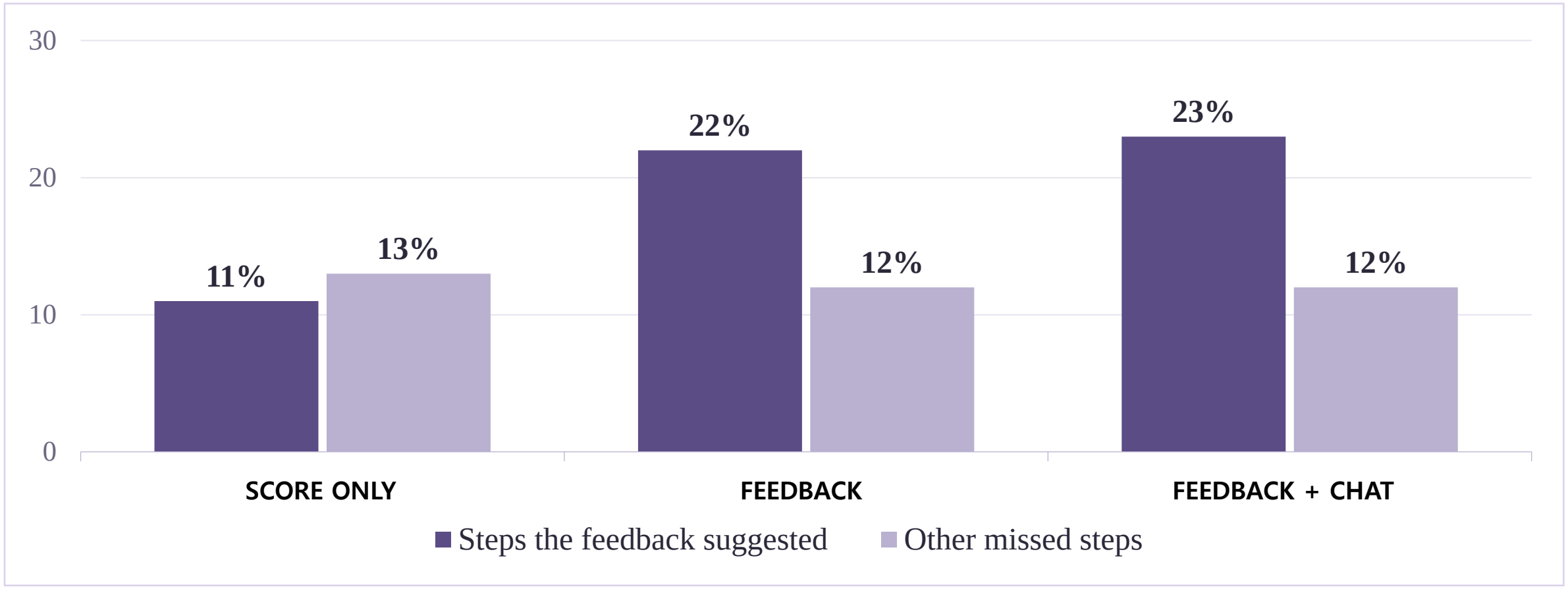
Feedback: + 0.38 points

No improvement without feedback

People took the steps their feedback suggested

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Share of missed Task 1 steps that people took in Task 2 (%)



What should we teach and assess?

Assess	**how people work and solve complex problems** Watch real work with AI, in low-stakes settings, **including in teams**
Teach	**through practice with specific feedback and opportunities to improve** Subject expertise, AI fluency, relational fluency, and adaptive flexibility
Recognize	**growth over time and learning from feedback** A record of what a person can do, for school, hiring, and new jobs

Where we are taking this work

We welcome partners in Korea: schools, universities, employers, and employment services.

1 Classrooms

Everyday AI: a new Cornell course for any student, from Spring 2027.

AI Fluency for Educators with teacher-inspired use cases.

2 Workplaces

Employers co-design tasks with us for their own jobs.

Open courses for general AI Fluency assessments.

3 Employment centers

Supporting job seekers in upskilling and showing AI skills.

Advising for mobility and identifying suitable positions.

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It’s 2030.

Jiyoung still has her job because she could show her employer what she can do.

Each month she practices the situations she finds hardest with specific feedback.

Her record now shows what she can do. **She is no longer hidden.**



Thank you

Rene Kizilcec

Cornell AI-Ready Workforce Initiative | ai-ready-workforce.ai.cornell.edu

Team: Michèle Belot, Steven Jackson, Thorsten Joachims, JR Keller, Philipp Kircher, Paul Krause, Rachel Slama, and Cornell students

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